

Valentin Nikolaev

Backend Developer

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Summary

Backend engineer with 15+ years in PHP and Go production systems. Experienced in Laravel, MySQL, APIs, performance work, and dependable delivery for web products.

Skills

PHP, Go, Laravel, Symfony, MySQL, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, AWS, Kubernetes, RabbitMQ, Elasticsearch, GitHub Actions, Helm, ArgoCD, monitoring.

Experience

Simple.life — Software Developer

November 2023 – July 2026

- Designed and owned a Go support-automation platform connecting Zendesk, Intercom, and internal services.
- Built message pipelines with retries, fallback logic, and monitoring. Technologies: Go, REST APIs, Zendesk, Intercom, monitoring.

CRURATED — PHP Software Developer, concurrent part-time consulting engagement

August 2024 – January 2026

- Architected internal event analytics infrastructure using queues and EventBridge.
- Built fault-tolerant routing and observability for downstream delivery. Technologies: PHP, queues, AWS EventBridge, webhooks, S3, observability.

airSlate — Senior Software Developer / Technical Lead

February 2021 – August 2023

- Optimized API and database bottlenecks and migrated services from ECS to Kubernetes.
- Built Laravel/Symfony logging and CI/CD delivery workflows. Technologies: PHP, Laravel, Symfony, MySQL, Elasticsearch, RabbitMQ, AWS, Kubernetes, Helm, ArgoCD.

Hypr — Technical Lead

November 2019 – January 2021

- Led backend delivery from prototype to closed beta in under six months. Technologies: PHP, Go, Laravel, MySQL, AWS, Kubernetes, microservices.

PDFfiller — Technical Lead

October 2016 – December 2018

- Led five backend engineers building transactional email systems handling about 50 million emails monthly. Technologies: PHP, Laravel, MySQL, Elasticsearch, RabbitMQ, AWS, DNS, DKIM, SPF, DMARC.

Education

MSc in Computer Science, National Technical University, Kharkiv, 2003–2008

Languages

Ukrainian (native); English (upper-intermediate / professional working).